

GlobalTrust Financial Services

Data Retention Policy

Legal & Information Governance Department

Document ID	GTFS-LEGAL-001
Version	2.0
Classification	Internal
Owner	Legal & Information Governance Department
Approved By	Sophia Ng, General Counsel
Effective Date	01 January 2026
Review Date	01 January 2027

Table of Contents

1. Purpose
2. Scope
3. Record Classification
4. Data Lifecycle
5. Retention Schedule
6. Legal Hold Process
7. Secure Disposal
8. Roles & Responsibilities
9. Audit & Compliance
10. Frequently Asked Questions
11. Appendices

1. Purpose

This Data Retention Policy establishes minimum retention periods and disposal requirements for all records created, received, or maintained by GlobalTrust Financial Services (GTFS). It supports regulatory compliance, legal defensibility, and customer privacy across all GTFS operations in Singapore, Dubai, Mumbai, and London.

- **Regulatory compliance** — Meet MAS, tax, employment, and AML record-keeping requirements.
- **Legal obligations** — Preserve records for litigation, audit, and regulatory examination.
- **Operational efficiency** — Reduce storage costs through defined disposal schedules.
- **Customer privacy** — Limit retention to necessary periods per GTFS-SEC-001.
- **Risk reduction** — Align with GTFS-RISK-001 information risk management framework.

LEGAL NOTICE: Legal Hold overrides all retention schedules until formally released by the Legal Department. No records subject to legal hold may be altered or destroyed.

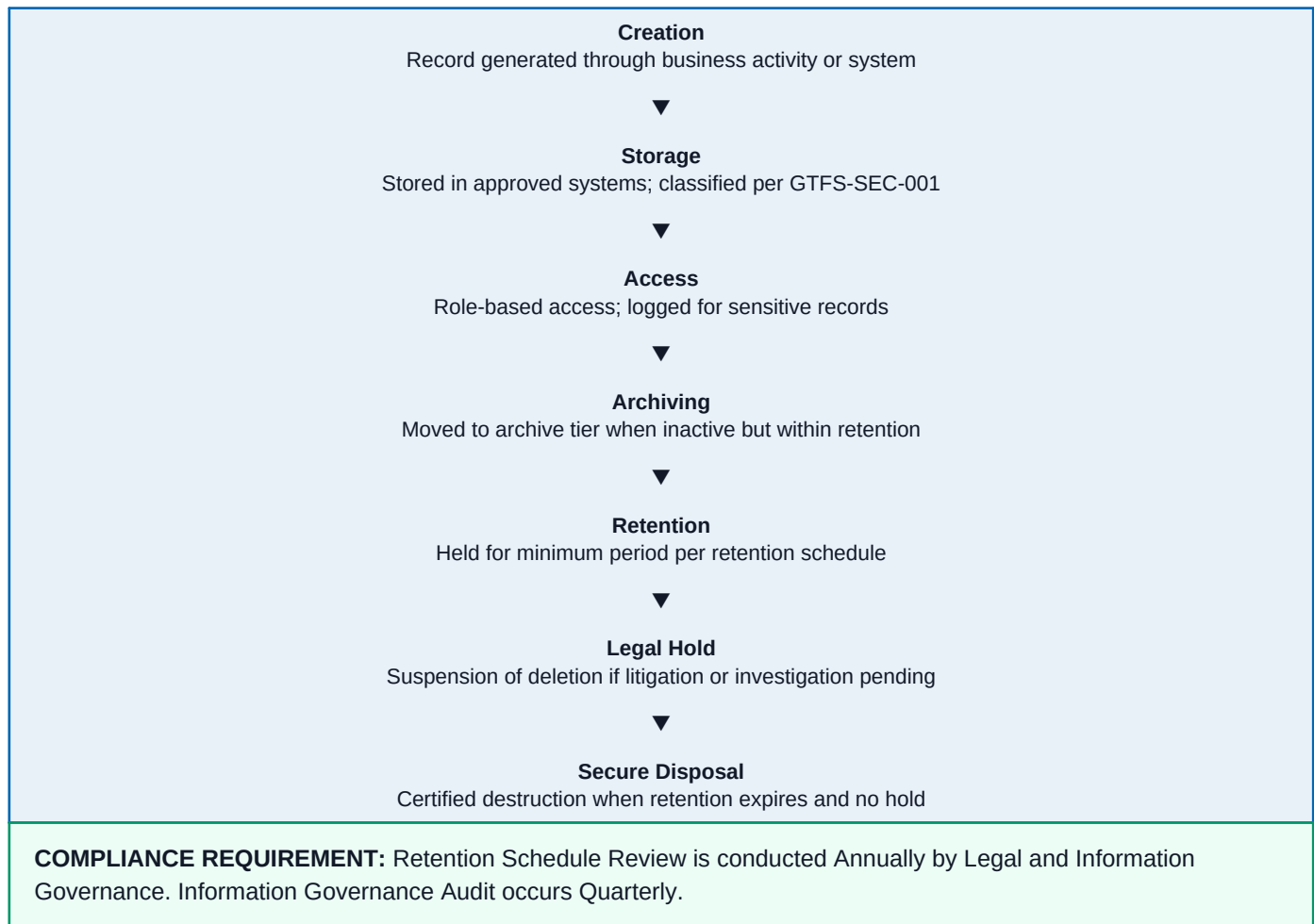
2. Scope

- All GTFS employees, contractors, and third-party vendors processing GTFS records.
- Cloud systems, on-premise systems, paper records, and electronic records.
- All business units: Retail, Commercial, Corporate, Mortgage, Treasury, HR, Legal, IT.
- Records regardless of format: email, documents, databases, logs, backups, and physical media.

3. Record Classification

Record Category	Description	Primary Owner	Classification
Customer Records	Account files, statements, correspondence	Operations	Confidential
Financial Records	General ledger, financial statements, budgets	Finance	Confidential
Employee Records	HR files, contracts, performance reviews	Human Resources	Restricted
Legal Documents	Contracts, litigation files, legal opinions	Legal	Restricted
Audit Records	Internal and external audit reports	Internal Audit	Confidential
Compliance Records	AML, KYC, regulatory filings	Compliance	Confidential
IT Logs	System, application, and access logs	IT	Internal
Security Logs	VPN, SIEM, firewall logs per GTFS-SEC-001	Information Security	Restricted
Emails	Business correspondence	All employees	Per content classification
Contracts	Vendor and customer agreements	Legal / Procurement	Confidential
Invoices	Accounts payable and receivable	Finance	Internal
Meeting Minutes	Board, committee, and management committee	Corporate Secretariat	Restricted

4. Data Lifecycle



5. Retention Schedule

Record Type	Retention Period	Trigger Event	Disposal Method
Customer Account Records	3 years	After account closure	Secure digital wipe
Loan Files	7 years	After final repayment	Secure digital wipe
Mortgage Files	15 years	After loan closure	Secure archive then wipe
AML Investigation Records	7 years	After case closure	Encrypted archive; certified disposal
KYC Records	7 years	After relationship ends	Per GTFS-COMP-002
Financial Statements	10 years	End of fiscal year	Archive; secure disposal
Tax Records	7 years	End of tax year	Secure digital wipe
Audit Reports	10 years	Report issuance date	Archive; restricted access
Employment Records	7 years	After employee separation	Secure digital wipe
Payroll Records	7 years	End of pay period	Secure digital wipe
Email	5 years	Date sent/received	Automated purge
Complaint Records	7 years	After complaint closure	Per GTFS-OPS-003

IT & Security Log Retention

Log Type	Retention Period	Storage	Notes
Security Logs (general)	365 days	SIEM	Per GTFS-SEC-001
VPN Logs	365 days	Security infrastructure	Access audit support
SIEM Logs	365 days	Central SIEM platform	Incident investigation
Application Logs	365 days	Log management system	Operational troubleshooting

Backup Retention Schedule

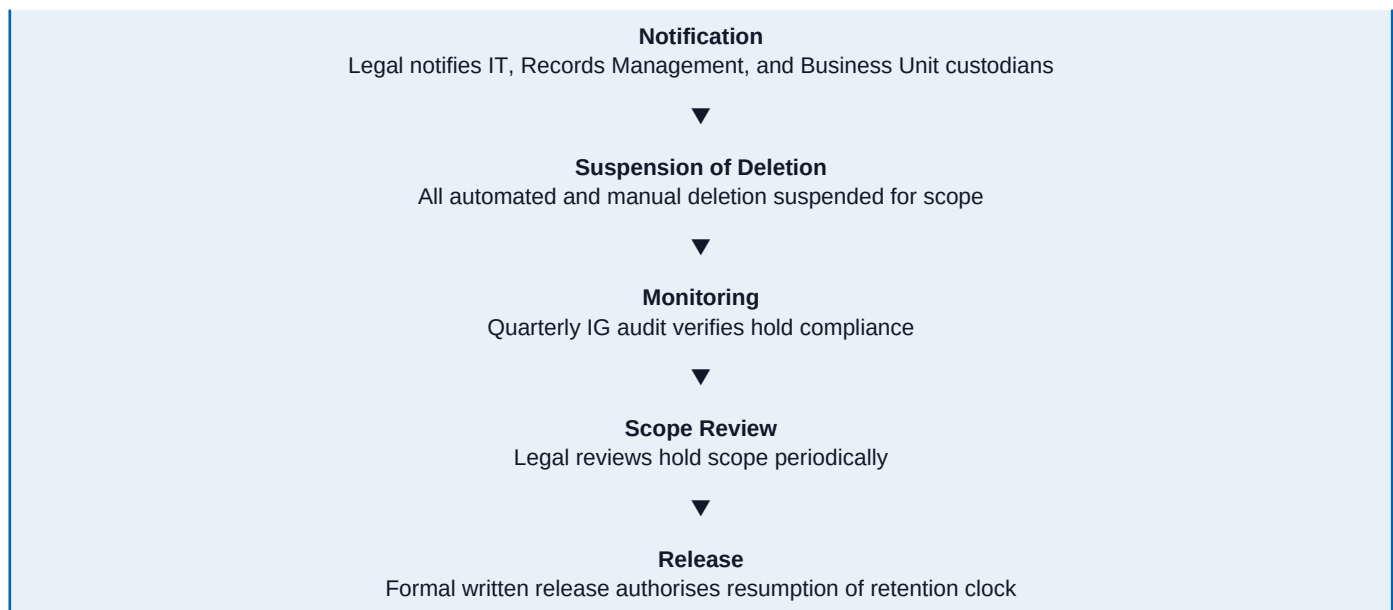
Backup Type	Retention Period	Purpose
Daily Backups	30 days	Operational recovery per GTFS-BCP-001
Weekly Backups	12 weeks	Extended recovery window
Monthly Backups	12 months	Quarterly restore testing
Annual Backups	7 years	Long-term regulatory and audit recovery
Backup Retention (general policy)	90 days minimum	Default for non-tiered backups

6. Legal Hold Process

Legal Hold Request

Legal Counsel identifies need (litigation, investigation, regulatory)





Step	Responsible Party	Action	Timeline
Hold initiation	Legal Counsel	Issue legal hold notice with scope	Within 1 business day
Custodian notification	Legal / IG	Notify all record custodians	Within 2 business days
Deletion suspension	IT	Disable auto-purge for affected records	Within 1 business day
Hold register update	Information Governance	Log hold in central register	Same day
Hold review	Legal	Assess continued need	Quarterly
Hold release	General Counsel	Written release notice	Upon matter closure

IMPORTANT: Destroying records under active legal hold is a serious compliance violation that may result in sanctions, adverse inference, and disciplinary action.

7. Secure Disposal

Disposal Method	Applicable Media	Standard	Verification
Paper shredding	Physical documents	Cross-cut shredding (P-4 minimum)	Destruction log
Digital wiping	Hard drives, SSDs	NIST 800-88 compliant wipe	Within 5 business days
Cryptographic erasure	Encrypted storage	Key destruction	IT verification certificate
Backup destruction	Tape, cloud backup snapshots	Overwrite or cryptographic erasure	Backup admin sign-off
Media disposal	USB, optical media, mobile devices	Physical destruction or degaussing	Media Destruction Certification mandatory
Vendor-certified destruction	Bulk hardware, off-site media	Approved vendor chain of custody	Certificate of destruction required

Secure Disposal Workflow



8. Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibilities
Legal	Legal hold issuance and release; retention policy governance; litigation support
Compliance	AML/KYC retention per GTFS-COMP-001 and GTFS-COMP-002; regulatory liaison
IT	System retention configuration; backup schedules; secure disposal execution
Information Security	Security log retention; disposal verification per GTFS-SEC-001

Role	Responsibilities
Business Units	Identify records; comply with retention schedule; respond to legal holds
Employees	Create and manage records per classification; no unauthorised deletion
Internal Audit	Annual retention compliance testing; report to Audit Committee
Information Governance	Retention schedule maintenance; Quarterly audit; disposal oversight

9. Audit & Compliance

- **Periodic audits** — Information Governance Audit conducted Quarterly.
- **Retention reviews** — Retention Schedule Review conducted Annually.
- **Exception reporting** — All retention exceptions logged and approved by Legal.
- **Regulatory inspections** — Records produced within regulatory timelines.

Audit Activity	Frequency	Owner	Output
Information Governance Audit	Quarterly	IG Team	Compliance report
Retention Schedule Review	Annually	Legal + IG	Updated schedule
Backup restore test	Quarterly	IT	BCP test report (GTFS-BCP-001)
Legal hold compliance check	Quarterly	Legal	Hold register review
Secure disposal audit	Annually	Internal Audit	Audit findings

Data Retention Case Studies

Case Study: Customer Account Closure

Situation: Retail customer closed savings account after 12-year relationship.

Applicable Retention Rule: Customer Account Records: 7 years after account closure.

Required Action: Account file moved to archive tier; deletion scheduled for January 2033.

Expected Outcome: Records available for regulatory inquiry until disposal date; no premature deletion.

Case Study: Employee Resignation

Situation: Senior analyst resigned after 5 years. HR initiated offboarding.

Applicable Retention Rule: Employment Records: 7 years after separation. Payroll Records: 7 years.

Required Action: HR files archived; payroll records retained in HRIS; access restricted.

Expected Outcome: Records retained until 2033; performance and payroll data available for disputes.

Case Study: Pending Litigation

Situation: Customer filed lawsuit regarding mortgage processing per GTFS-OPS-002.

Applicable Retention Rule: Legal Hold overrides all retention schedules until formally released.

Required Action: Legal issued hold notice; mortgage file and related emails preserved.

Expected Outcome: Automated deletion suspended; hold registered; quarterly review scheduled.

Case Study: Expired Loan Records

Situation: SME loan repaid in full in 2018; retention period expired in 2025.

Applicable Retention Rule: Loan Files: 7 years after final repayment.

Required Action: IG verified no legal hold; IT executed secure digital wipe.

Expected Outcome: Secure Deletion Verification completed within 5 business days; certificate filed.

Case Study: Security Log Retention

Situation: SIEM logs from Q1 2025 reached 365-day retention limit.

Applicable Retention Rule: SIEM Logs and VPN Logs: 365 days retention.

Required Action: Automated purge executed per log management policy.

Expected Outcome: Logs beyond 365 days securely deleted; current logs available for incident investigation.

Case Study: Cloud Storage Disposal

Situation: GTFS decommissioned legacy cloud storage bucket containing archived emails.

Applicable Retention Rule: Email Retention: 5 years. Annual Backups: 7 years.

Required Action: Vendor-certified destruction requested; cryptographic erasure of cloud volumes.

Expected Outcome: Media Destruction Certification received; disposal verified within 5 business days.

10. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: How long are customer account records kept?

A: 7 years after account closure.

Q: How long are loan files retained?

A: 7 years after final repayment.

Q: Mortgage file retention?

A: 15 years after loan closure.

Q: AML investigation records?

A: 7 years after case closure.

Q: KYC record retention?

A: 7 years after relationship ends (GTFS-COMP-002).

Q: Financial statement retention?

A: 10 years.

Q: Tax record retention?

A: 7 years.

Q: Audit report retention?

A: 10 years.

Q: Employment record retention?

A: 7 years after employee separation.

Q: Payroll record retention?

A: 7 years.

Q: Email retention period?

A: 5 years.

Q: Security log retention?

A: 365 days.

Q: VPN log retention?

A: 365 days.

Q: SIEM log retention?

A: 365 days.

Q: General backup retention?

A: 90 days minimum; tiered schedule applies.

Q: Daily backup retention?

A: 30 days.

Q: Weekly backup retention?

A: 12 weeks.

Q: Monthly backup retention?

A: 12 months.

Q: Annual backup retention?

A: 7 years.

Q: What happens during legal hold?

A: Legal Hold overrides all retention schedules until formally released.

Q: Secure deletion verification timeline?

A: Within 5 business days.

Q: Is destruction certification required?

A: Yes — Media Destruction Certification is mandatory.

Q: Information Governance audit frequency?

A: Quarterly.

Q: Retention schedule review frequency?

A: Annually.

Q: Can I delete records early?

A: No — requires Legal and IG approval; never if legal hold applies.

11. Appendices

Appendix A — Retention Schedule (Summary)

Refer to Section 5 for the complete retention schedule.

Appendix B — Legal Hold Checklist

- Legal hold notice issued by Legal Counsel
- Scope of records identified (systems, dates, custodians)
- IT notified — automated deletion suspended
- Business unit custodians notified within 2 business days
- Hold registered in central legal hold register
- Quarterly hold review scheduled
- Written release obtained before resuming disposal

Appendix C — Data Classification Matrix

Classification	Examples	Access	Retention Basis
Public	Marketing materials, published reports	Unrestricted	Business need
Internal	Meeting minutes, internal memos	GTFS employees	5–7 years typical
Confidential	Customer records, financial data	Need-to-know	Per retention schedule
Restricted	Legal files, security logs, HR records	Authorised only	Per retention schedule + legal hold

Appendix D — Storage Media Comparison

Media Type	Typical Use	Disposal Method	Certification Required
Cloud storage	Active records, archives	Cryptographic erasure	Vendor certificate
On-premise SAN/NAS	Core banking, databases	Digital wipe (NIST 800-88)	IT verification
Backup tape	Disaster recovery	Degaussing or physical destruction	Mandatory
Paper records	Legacy files, contracts	Cross-cut shredding (P-4+)	Destruction log
Removable media	Temporary transfers	Physical destruction	Mandatory

Appendix E — Information Governance Contacts

Function	Contact
Information Governance	ig@gtfs.internal
Legal — Records & Hold	legal-records@gtfs.internal
General Counsel	gc@gtfs.com
Records Management	records@gtfs.internal
Secure Disposal Requests	disposal@gtfs.internal

Figure — Retention Decision Tree

Record Identified for Disposal

Legal Hold active? → Yes: Suspend deletion; notify Legal

Retention period expired? → No: Continue retention

Regulatory minimum met? → Verify against retention schedule

Business need exists? → Extend with IG approval if justified

Approve secure disposal → IT / Records Management

Verify deletion → Within 5 business days

Certificate of destruction → Mandatory for media disposal

COMMON MISTAKE: Storing records beyond the retention period without justification increases data breach risk and violates GTFS-SEC-001 data minimisation principles.

Document Control

Document ID: GTFS-LEGAL-001 | Version 2.0 | Classification: Internal

Approved By: Sophia Ng, General Counsel | Effective: 01 January 2026 | Review: 01 January 2027

Generated: 28 June 2026